Past Continuous

when / while — Interrupted & Parallel

Level 3 — when & while

Name: _____ Date: _____

1 Definition · التعريف

نختار بين when و while حسب الفعل: when + ماضٍ بسيط (حدث قصير)، و while + ماضٍ مستمر (حدث طويل جارٍ).

Choose when or while by the verb: when + past simple (short), while + past continuous (long).

While + was/were V-ing … / … when + past simple

2 Key Facts · حقائق أساسية

★ when + ماضٍ بسيط (القصير) · while + ماضٍ مستمر (الطويل الجاري).

when + past simple (short); while + past continuous (long).

★ المعنى نفسه بصياغتين: I was reading when the phone rang = While I was reading, the phone rang.

Same meaning both ways (when / while).

★ حدثان طويلان متوازيان: While I was cooking, he was cleaning.

Two long parallel actions: while + past continuous for both.

★ فاصلة إذا بدأت الجملة بـ When/While.

Comma when the sentence starts with When/While.

while + past continuous	when + past simple
While I was reading, the phone rang.	When the phone rang, I was reading.
While I was cooking, he was cleaning.	I was sleeping when it happened.

3 Steps · خطوات النجاح

فعل قصير مفاجئ؟ → when + past simple . فعل طويل جارٍ؟ → while + was/were V-ing .

Short sudden action? → when + past simple. Long ongoing action? → while + was/were V-ing.

while

While we were walking, it started to rain.

when

I was studying when my friend arrived.

متوازيان

While my mother was cooking, I was helping her.

4 Summary · الخلاصة

✦ تذكّر/ي دائمًا · Remember

when + قصير (بسيط) · while + طويل (مستمر) · فاصلة إذا بدأت بالعبارة.

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Let's Practice!

1 Recognize · تعرّف

Choose the past continuous or the past simple.
اختر/ي الماضي المستمر أو الماضي البسيط.

1. While I _____ , I saw a friend. (was walking / walked)
2. When the teacher _____ in, we were talking. (was coming / came)
3. They were playing when it _____ to rain. (was starting / started)
4. While she _____ , the phone rang. (was cooking / cooked)

2 Multiple Choice · اختيار من متعدد

Choose when or while.
اختر/ي when أو while.

1. _____ I was reading, the lights went out. a) When b) While
2. I was sleeping _____ the earthquake happened. a) when b) while
3. _____ my brother was studying, I was watching TV. a) When b) While

3 Fill in · إكمال الفراغ

Use the past continuous for long actions and the past simple for short ones.
استخدم/ي الماضي المستمر للأحداث الطويلة والبسيط للقصيرة.

1. While we _____ (have) lunch, the guests _____ (arrive).
2. I _____ (watch) TV when the power _____ (go) off.
3. While my mother _____ (cook), my father _____ (water) the plants.
4. When you _____ (call), I _____ (study) in my room.

4 Match · توصيل

Match each clause with its ending — write the letter.
صِل/ي كل بداية بنهايتها — اكتب/ي الحرف.

1) While I was studying,	____	a) we were playing outside.
2) When the rain started,	____	b) when I fell down.
3) I was riding my bike	____	c) my brother was watching TV.

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Keep Going!

5 Transform · تحويل

Join the sentences with when or while.
اربط/ي الجملتين بـ when أو while.

1. I was cooking. The phone rang. → .....

2. My mother was cooking. My father was cleaning. → .....

6 Correct · تصحيح خطأ

Each sentence has one mistake. Correct it.
في كل جملة خطأ واحد. صحّح/يه.

1. I was read when she called. → .....

2. While they played, it started to snow. → .....

3. When I was cooking, I was cutting my finger. → .....

7 In Context · توظيف سياقي

Use the past continuous or the past simple for each verb.
استخدم/ي الماضي المستمر أو البسيط لكل فعل.

It was a quiet afternoon in Jaffa. While my grandfather (1) _____ (tell) us a story, the electricity suddenly (2) _____ (go) off. We (3) _____ (sit) in the dark when my mother (4) _____ (bring) a lamp. While she (5) _____ (light) it, we all (6) _____ (laugh).

8 Create · تحدٍ إبداعي

Write one sentence with when and one with while about yesterday.
اكتب/ي جملة بـ when وأخرى بـ while عن أمس.

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Answer Key

🔑 Answer Key · مفتاح الإجابات للمعلمة

تمرين ١: was walking · came · started · was cooking

تمرين ٢: b) While · a) when · b) While

تمرين ٣: were having / arrived · was watching / went · was cooking / was watering · called / was studying

تمرين ٤: 1 → c · 2 → a · 3 → b

تمرين ٥: I was cooking when the phone rang. · While my mother was cooking, my father was cleaning.

تمرين ٦: I was reading when she called. · While they were playing, it started to snow. · When I was cooking, I cut my finger.

تمرين ٧: 1 was telling · 2 went · 3 were sitting · 4 brought · 5 was lighting · 6 laughed

تمرين ٨: إجابات مفتوحة! (when + ماضٍ بسيط · while + ماضٍ مستمر).

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